

Users who switch to PhotoDemon 9.0 from a previous version may immediately notice the new user interface. The majority of options now display as flyout panels, and the most used tools appear right on the toolbar. The new user interface, according to the creator, uses “less than half of the vertical space of the old design” without sacrificing functionality.



The user interface is still made to work with a variety of display resolutions, including traditional ones like 1024×768. With the makeover, photographs that are opened in the editor have more space. Support

for multiple selections is included in the most recent release. *Add*, *Subtract*, and *Intersect* can be used to combine selections, and even when several selections are active, the final selection is still editable.

The content-aware fill tool, often known as smart object removal or inpainting, is another new function. Although the tool operates automatically, there are settings and adjusting choices to personalise the process.

AMD joins PyTorch Foundation as founding member

AMD is joining the newly created PyTorch Foundation as a founding member. The foundation, which will be part of the non-profit Linux Foundation, will drive adoption of AI tooling by fostering and sustaining an ecosystem of open source projects with PyTorch, the machine learning (ML) software framework originally created and fostered by Meta. As a founding member, AMD joins others in the industry to prioritise the continued growth of PyTorch’s vibrant community. Supported by innovations such as the AMD ROCm open software platform, AMD Instinct accelerators, adaptive SoCs and CPUs, AMD will help the PyTorch Foundation by working to democratize state-of-the-art tools, libraries and other components to make these ML innovations accessible to everyone.

“Open software is critical to advancing HPC, AI and ML research, and we’re ready to bring our experience with open software platforms and innovation to the PyTorch foundation,” said Brad McCredie, corporate vice president, Data Center and Accelerated Processing, AMD. “AMD Instinct accelerators and ROCm software power important HPC and ML sites around the world, from exascale supercomputers at research labs to major cloud deployments showcasing the convergence of HPC and AI/ML. Together with other foundation members, we will support the acceleration of science and research that can make a dramatic impact on the world.”

“We are excited to have AMD join the PyTorch Foundation and bring its extensive expertise in HPC, AI and ML to our members,” said Santosh Janardhan, VP, Infrastructure at Meta. “AMD has continued to support PyTorch with its integration on ROCm open software platform, and has worked extensively with the open source community and other foundation members to advance performance of ML and AI workloads. The collaborative support offered by AMD continues our engagement across broad industry initiatives for global impact.”

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LinkedIn’s Feathr joins the LF AI & Data Foundation

LinkedIn, a business networking site owned by Microsoft Corp., has announced that its Feathr feature store has joined the AI & Data Foundation of the Linux Foundation. Feathr was created by LinkedIn and launched in 2017 to simplify, accelerate, and scale up feature serving in machine learning, particularly for real-time AI applications. According to a blog post by LinkedIn engineers Hangfei Lin and Jinghui Mo, the company’s AI teams use Feathr to store, transform, serve, and distribute features with high throughput and low latency.

Feathr acts as an abstraction layer between the raw data and machine learning models, making it easier to standardise and make machine learning workflows and apps for feature definition, transformation, serving, storage, and access. When Feathr connects to numerous databases, developers can concentrate more on feature engineering while letting Feathr handle data serialisation types. Additionally, it offers options for managing credentials and optimising performance.

Feathr enables authors of machine learning algorithms to create features only once and use them across a variety of contexts, including model training and model serving. Additionally, they have the ability to connect to multiple offline data sources, like data lakes and data warehouses, and convert the data contained within into machine learning characteristics.

Since its debut, Feathr has grown to power numerous AI applications at LinkedIn, where it is employed to manage a large number of features.

